

MAHIMA S: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (2025)

ENGINEER TRAINEE IN AMERICAN EXPRESS

About the Company:

The American Express Company, or Amex, is an American bank holding company and multinational financial services corporation specializing in payment cards. They leverage advanced data analytics, cloud infrastructure, secure APIs, machine learning, and a hybrid cloud environment to provide a seamless, secure, and personalized experience for users. The company's technological investments support not only transaction processing but also fraud prevention, regulatory compliance, and customer engagement, making it a leader in the digital finance space.

About the role:

The Engineer Trainee role at American Express involves developing scalable, mission-critical applications on cloud platforms using languages such as Java, Python, and JavaScript. The work spans various tech domains, including real-time transaction processing, big data, AI/ML, and omnichannel solutions for mobile and social integrations. The role includes collaborating with skilled engineers on design, coding, and Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) tasks. It also fosters a culture of innovation, continuous learning, and experimentation with cutting-edge technologies.

Overview of the process:

- Coding test (Online)
- Technical Interview (Online)
- HR Interview (Online)

Online coding test:

The coding test was conducted on the Codility platform. It included three coding questions, focused on String manipulation, Greedy approach and Graph. Only three test cases were visible, while the rest were hidden. Scores were based on the number of hidden test cases that passed, so it was essential to handle all edge cases correctly for successful completion.

Interview Round I:

Duration: 1 hour 15 mins

Platform: Webex

Panel: 2 interviewers

The interview was mainly project and tech-stack focused.

- I was asked to explain my projects in detail, along with the technologies used.
- Since I had mentioned *Honours*, they asked a few questions related to that area.

- Questions on **recursion** and different **sorting techniques** were included.
- They asked about **DBMS concepts**, with a particular focus on SQL queries and indexing.
- My **AI/DL project** was discussed in depth—especially the workflow and the **BiLSTM model** I had implemented.
- Some non-technical questions were also asked, such as *“Where do you see yourself in the future?”* and even *“Do you see yourself in our position someday?”*
- The round ended with *“Do you have any questions for us?”*

Interview Round II:

Duration: 45 mins

Platform: Webex

Panel: 1 interviewer

This round was a mix of technical and aptitude.

- Started with *“Tell me about yourself”*.
- A **coding problem on strings** was given, and I was asked to share my screen and run the code.
- An **aptitude question on ratio and proportion** followed.
- Project-related questions, along with concepts from **Keras and TensorFlow**, were discussed.
- I was also asked about **React Native components** and **DBMS normalization**.
- Behavioral and HR-type questions included *“Why Amex?”* and *“Where do you see yourself in the future?”*
- Finally, the interviewer asked if I had any questions for them.

Tricks I Followed:

- Went through **interview experiences** from GFG and other websites.
- I brushed up on **DSA, DBMS, SQL, OOPS, System Design and OS**.
- Prepared both **project explanations** and **common HR answers**.
- Tailored my **self-introduction** as per the job description.
- Had a few **questions ready for the interviewer** to show genuine interest in the role.

Preparation Strategy

- For DSA, I followed the Striver DSA Sheet to revise important coding problems.
- For DBMS, I practiced from InterviewBit, GeeksforGeeks (GFG), and TakeUForward.
- For OS, I revised key concepts from GFG.

- For OOPs, I focused on core concepts and implementations.
- The CUIC training sessions helped me strengthen my aptitude preparation.
- Be Confident in What you mention in your Resume. Be Fair and Stay Positive. Also Study System Design concepts.